Parks Commission Recreation - Report 9/9/2026

Dunbar Community Center

- **Attendance**: 2026 – 1,978

Youth Programs

- **Star Student Afterschool:** registration opened August 1st. began August 11, 2026: 60 enrolled

Youth Athletics

- **Youth Flag Football:** practice started in August, 30 enrolled; games began August 24 and are played at West Central
- **Cheer:** 15 enrolled – practice @DCC and will cheer @8U Flag Football games starting in September.
- **Youth Volleyball Clinic**: Was held August 3 - 6.
- **Youth Volleyball**: 17 enrolled: practice Monday - Thursday (6 – 7:30pm)

Special Activity: LRPR Star Student- Water Safety program August 25th – September 24th at Southwest Community Center (Tuesdays/Thursday from 3:30 p.m. - 5:30 p.m.)

Adult Programs

- **Dunbar Line Dancing:** Manday/ Tuesday. (cost $10/$3 senior monthly/day, $15/$5 Adult monthly/day)

Facility Vacancies: Facility Supervisor, 3-Part-Time Activity Assistant, 1- Part-time Time Custodian.

Special Event: Back to school event August 1st was a free event.

Cooling Center: Monday through Friday, 8 a.m. to 8:30 p.m. & Saturday 9 a.m. to 5 p.m.

Southwest Community Center

Cooling Center: Monday through Friday, 8 a.m. to 8:30 p.m. & Saturday 9 a.m. to 5 p.m.

Youth Programs:

- **Junior Botanist Program:** Partnered with Dunbar Gardens with an average of 10 potential Jr. Botanist attending. It has also partnered with other division within the Parks and Recreation department.
- **Home School Recreation Hour:** Program registration began August 3rd and will remain open until further notice
- **SW Beehives Beekeepers Program:** Involves caring for, managing, and inspecting honeybee colonies. It also includes collecting/processing honey as well as providing bees with a safe environment and enough food.
- **Southwest Builds**: has officially launched on social media and ActiveNet registration is open for ages 13+. The first meeting is September 16, introducing participants to basic tools, proper handling, and hands-on skills. As the program grows, so will its impact, with future plans to take on real-world community improvement projects.
- **Youth Dance Class:** Monday/Wednesday 5:00p.m.-7:00p.m. & Saturdays 9:00 -11:00 a.m. cost $10 per month per participant
- **Free Art Night:** Wednesdays from 6pm-8pm, monthly membership.

Southwest Youth Athletics

- **Youth Volleyball:** Free fundamentals clinics was August 25-27, 6pm-7:30pm, for students grades 4th-7th. The clinics provided a great opportunity to sharpen skills before team practices begin while giving new players a chance to try volleyball.

- **Learn to Swim Program:** Weekly, lessons for all skill levels at $50 for five sessions. Morning and evening class options are available.
- **Water Safety Program:** Is offered to the Star Student Afterschool participants from each Community Center for 5 weeks August 25 – September 24.
- **Youth Football**: League games began August 24; games are played at West Central Com. Center.

Southwest Adult Programs

- **Southwest Steppers Dance Workout Class:** attendance remains high, new social media post has been created for promotions.
- **Art Class:** for ages 18+ last Tuesday of each month 12pm – 2pm
- **Walking Club:** Members and guest experiences walking the trails at Southwest Com. Center with a staff, miles are recorded and incentives received periodically. Currently 4 members
- **Low-Impact Senior Workout**: Video-based program with about 15 members and guests aged 65 and up.
- **Pickleball**: Beginners Thursday mornings 9:00 am-10:00 am.

****Special Events & Community Outreach:** SW Beehive, SW Builds, Vibes and Versus Open Mike

Stephens Community Center

- **Activities:** Layne Day Back to School Bash – 400+ participants. Dress Lie Mike or Not Dance – 47 participants.
- **Star Student Afterschool:** Started August 11, there are 36 participants.
- **Youth Sports Program:** Flag Football – 36; Cheerleaders - 21
- **Staff Outreach Activities:** Open House informational table and back to school greet first day at Stephens Elementary
- **Facility Vacancies:** 3 – part-time Activity Assistants; 2-Part-Time or 1-Full-Time Custodians.
- **Maintenance:** Leak in the ceiling at the front door. Need lines on the floor for Volleyball and Youth Basketball.
- **Special Activity:** LRPR Star Student- Water Safety program August 25th – September 24th at Southwest Community Center (Tuesdays/Thursday from 3:30 p.m. - 5:30 p.m.
- **Upcoming:** Saturdays September Awesome Science with the Museum of Discovery; Taste of Stephens (Wednesday, September 23, 2026) 6:00 --8:30 pm $5 per person

West Central Community Center

- **Cooling Center**: Monday through Friday, 8 a.m. to 8:30 p.m. & Saturday 9 a.m. to 5 p.m.
- **Youth Sports:** Flag Football season has started, WCCC has 62 participants, cheer has 20, and volleyball has 6.
- **Classes:** Karate 28 (3 age groups), Youth Dance 10 (on break until September), Adult Line dance 15 in Tuesday/Thursday day classes and 20 in Wednesday evening classes. Active living classes for seniors are Monday-Friday averaging about 150 participants per week.
- **Community Outreach**: Book Drive has brought in over 120 books.
- **Programming:** August 26 Family Card Night had about 20 people.
- **Rentals:** 15 including neighborhood Associations and COLR business meetings.
- **Staffing:** 2 Act. Assistant have been selected and are in the hiring process
- **Maintenance:** The outside of the building has been power washed for the year.
- **Special Activity:** LRPR Star Student- Water Safety program August 25th – September 24th at Southwest Community Center (Tuesdays/Thursday from 3:30 p.m. - 5:30 p.m.)

ELR Community Center

- **Trainings:** Cybersecurity/Series, Safety (Job Hazard Analysis)
- **Attendance:** 381
- **Community Use:** CHI ST. Vincent Back to School Physicals , Neighborhood Association, Grounds, Outdoor courts and park areas used 3–5 days/week for recreation, trainings, and fitness.
- **Maintenance:** Grounds upkeep ongoing; tennis courts in need of refurbishment.
- **Meetings:** Park STAT, Staff meetings, CAPRA, Work Order, Neighborhood meeting August 10 next meeting September 14.

Senior Affairs

- **Attendance:** 3,358 all locations total
- **Community Outreach:** Baptist Health held their monthly outreach**,** monthly health screening all locations and food distributions (Dunbar/East LR & Southwest).
- **Events:** West Central: MLK Back 2 School giveaway, Golden Tee Golf, Financial Seminar, East LR: Shopping, Movies (Ron Robinson), Field Trips, Southwest: birthday celebrations, Funday. All Locations had Senior Pool Day at Southwest Swimming Pool. Dunbar had story Telling and Lunch outings. All locations had Baptist Health visits on various days.
- **Monthly Activities:** Chair volleyball, bean bag baseball, Birthday celebrations, Bingo/connect bingo, Bean Bag Baseball, Pickle Ball, Price is Right, Dominoes, Arts & Crafts, Guest Speakers, Field Trips, Bible Study, bowling, painting, Line Dancing, Mind Bending, Ring Toss, Silver Foxes Dance Class, Senior Chair Fitness, walking club, Quilting, Puzzles, Adult Coloring, Jewelry Making, Skip-Bo, Card/Table Games, and Free play
- **Upcoming Program:** Aging & Active Summit September 10 @West Central 8:00am – 3:00pm, Fishing for Seniors @MacArthur Park September 18 9:30am – 12noon

Therapeutic Recreation

Fall Program:

- **Branch Out Adult Day Program**
  Enrollment- 21 registered, Activities include: Morning movement/fitness, art projects to be included in the TR aRT Gallery event, baking challenge, community outings, sports programming, etc.
  Volunteer Service: Fellowship Bible Church: Women's Event; August 27th. Fellowship Bible Church is one our volunteer partnerships within the community.
- **Time Out for TR: 19 registered,** Activities include**:** Frost Your Cake, Baking/Decorating Class- Sept. 11th

Community Outings:

- Murry's Dinner Playhouse- Sept. 3: 17 registered
- **Special Events: : (1) Logan's Run**-- Registration is open for Logan's Run to be held on September 26th at War Memorial Park at 9:00am. This is a non-competitive event that offers children ages 5 and up with intellectual, developmental, and/or physical disabilities the opportunity to enhance their physical activity while focusing on reaching a goal. This event will be a 2K race and is a kickoff event for **(2) 2026 All-Abilities Division** of Little Rock Marathon to be on Saturday, March 6th. **(3) The 3rd Annual aRT Gallery** will be held on Friday, September 18th at 6pm at the MacArthur Museum of Arkansas Military History. This is a public event and features art projects from multiple mediums created by the participants of the Branch Out program. Artists will have 7 art installments on display at the gallery.

Jim Dailey Fitness & Aquatics

- **Programs:** 19 group fitness classes; strong participation. Senior fit class average 55 per class.
- **Upcoming Events: Tai Chi Dailey Flow**: Date: September 9, 2026 Time: 9:00 AM Ages: 18+ Cost: Free; **Lunch & Learn: Health and Wellness Series:** (Jim Dailey Fitness & Aquatic Center has partnered with Natural Grocers) to offer a series of educational Lunch & Learn sessions featuring a variety of health and wellness topics Starting Date: September 2, 2026 Schedule: Every other Wednesday Time: 12:00 PM Cost: Free; **Step Fit – New Fitness Class:** Date: September 8, 2026 Tuesday: 7:00 AM Saturday: 10:00 AM; **Pickleball Lessons** – New Program: Starting Date: September 2, 2026 Time: 9:00 AM Ages: 10+ Cost: Daily admission or monthly membership

The Centre at University Park (Currently Under Renovation)

Youth Athletics

- **Youth Flag Football:** 156 registered, league began on August 24, at West Central Com. Center
- **Youth Cheerleading:** 72 registered
- **Youth Volleyball:** registration is open

Adult Athletics

- **Interstate/Allsop/Murry Park Programs:** Field usage for Interstate Park fields 1,2 and 3 has been reserved for Kickball organization for the next 8 weeks starting in September on Sundays. Also working to start a coed Church softball league on Mondays at Interstate.
- **Allsop Park:** Field usage at Allsop Park has picked back up again with different organizations using the field for kickball for the next 6 weeks. As well as youth baseball practice.
- **Murry Park Volleyball Court:** Each Wednesdays court use slowed down due to heat.
- **LR Parks Summer Day Camp:** Planning for 2027 has started, trying to add an additional site and field trips to go on for 2027.
- **Adult Softball Program:** The professional corporate league of 14 teams league play at Interstate Sports complex ended August 14, 2026 playoffs started and is scheduled to end the first week of September on field 4.

First Tee Golf

- **Attendance:** 2026-5208
- **Activities:** 3 golf tournaments so far this year, with one more scheduled for October 16 and 17
- **Facility Vacancies:** 1 part-time cashier
- **Maintenance:** Open since aerification completed. New sod in the tee boxes are ready. Driving ranges are in good shape.
- **Revenue:** GROSS SALES YEAR/YEAR: JAN,1 TO August 25, 2026, $233,538.66 JAN, 1 TO August 18, 2025, $245,313.76 Down 4.5%

Rebsamen Golf (No Report Sent In)

Rebsamen Tennis

- **Season:** High school tennis matches began in August and will go through end of September Mixed Doubles USTA teams playing home matches, Tri-Level USTA teams playing home matches, Rebsamen specific men's singles and doubles leagues continued through the summer.

New USTA singles match play league played out of Rebsamen this summer, Raul and Janan summer programs currently running, Red ball league (for beginners) at least 3 courts every Friday night in August.

- **Evening Play:** With the Heat not much play during the day, more play after 6:00 pm each night
- **Maintenance:** Next step for courts is to put on the junior court lines on courts 3-10 (this is standard procedure and a USTA requirement for grant purposes).

Museum of Arkansas Military History

- **Attendance:** August attendance was 1,461 (664 walk-ins from twenty-seven states and Washington DC, as well as seven foreign countries (Australia, Chile, China, Germany, Indonesia, Italy and the Virgin Islands), 273 visitors for special events, meetings, and tours, 399 virtual views, 28 for Summer Day Camp programming and 97 off-site) YTD attendance: 20,573.
- **Staff**: David Collins is attending the National History Day Conference in Indianapolis, August 30 – September 2. Museum Supervisor Stephen McAteer attended a meeting of Central Arkansas museum/cultural sites/tourism directors hosted by Congressman French Hill on August 22.
- **Programs:** (1) After School Programs resumed at Stephens Community Center, with programs at Dunbar and West Central Community Centers resuming in September, (2) On-site adult tour for seniors from Indian Springs Church in Bryant, (3) Promotion ceremony for Samuel Fradsham, Arkansas National Guard.
- **Gift Shop Sales:** $839.43 (August) YTD Total: $8,771.87 (a 10% increase over 2025's record-breaking sales).
- **Fundraising:** $3,175 (August). YTD Total: $20,355.25.
- **Exhibits:** *Thomas Hart Benton* closed on August 9. *Clara Barton: Angel of the Battlefield,* a traveling exhibit from the National Museum of Civil War Medicine in Frederick, MD opened August 1. *Through Darkness to Light: Photographs Along the Underground Railroad* scheduled to open on September 4.
- **Presentations:** Off -site presentation to Civil War Roundtable of Arkansas on August 25.
- **Movies MacArthur:** *The Ghost Army,* on August 18. A record 148 persons attended the movie screening (third consecutive month in which a record attendance was set). YTD – 721, which is a record with three more months in the season (average of 90 per month).
- **Partnerships:** Arkansas National Guard, Korean American Federation of Arkansas, Freedom Sings Arkansas, Little Rock Central High School National Historic Site, Civil War Roundtable of Arkansas, National Museum of Civil War Medicine, Exhibits USA and Mid-America Arts Alliance.
- **Special Events:** (1) Little Rock Central High School National Historic Site's "Family Day on Little Rock Nine Way" on August 22.
- **Looking Ahead:** September 3 – Exhibit Opening Reception, *From Darkness to Light: Photographs Along the Underground Railroad;* September 11– "On the Road with Mark Christ: War Comes to the Ozarks" tour, 7 am – 7 pm; September 12 – Tinker Fest at the Museum of Discovery, 9 am – 3 pm; September 15 – 76th Anniversary Inchon Landing, 10 am – 1 pm; September 15 – Movies at MacArthur, *Time of Fear*, 6:30 – 8:30 pm; September 18 – aRT Gallery Reception, 6 – 8 pm; September 24 – AR Association of College History Teachers Fall Meeting, 12 – 6 pm; September 25 – AR Association of College History Teachers Fall Meeting, 9 am – 1:30 pm;

Outdoor Recreation

- **Program Attendance:** 195 adults, 18 youth
- **Facility usage:** War Memorial disc golf course: year to date # of players: 2,572 with 4,800 hours of usage

- **Activities:** Wednesday, 6am Arkansas River Trail “Banana rides”, Thursday, alternating Arkansas River Trail road ride and Boyle Park mountain bike rides, Disc golf event at War Memorial disc golf, ride leader for BDB100 training rides, (multiple programs were canceled due to excessive heat).
- **Maintenance**: Ongoing upkeep of War Memorial disc golf course (brush clearing, weed eating, trash removal, equipment repair/maintenance), replaced outdated fire extinguishers at War Memorial office, added new smoke and carbon monoxide detectors to WM office space
- **Accomplishments:** Listed Outdoor Recreation programs on LRCVB calendar, Little Rock Outdoor Recreation Facebook page surpassed 1,100 followers, up to date on cyber security trainings, signed up as lead for bike safety team at Creep-n-crawl run (held in Oct.), updated Guide ARK listing to include hiking, November trail running event registration has reached 43 participants (this is ahead of last year's registration at the same date), group rides attendance has seen record attendance,